GRAPHIC
DESIGN

GRAPHIC DESIGN

The Basics of the Pen Tool

Did you know?

Graphic design is constantly changing

Keep learning everyday

The biggest threat is thinking you have it all figured out

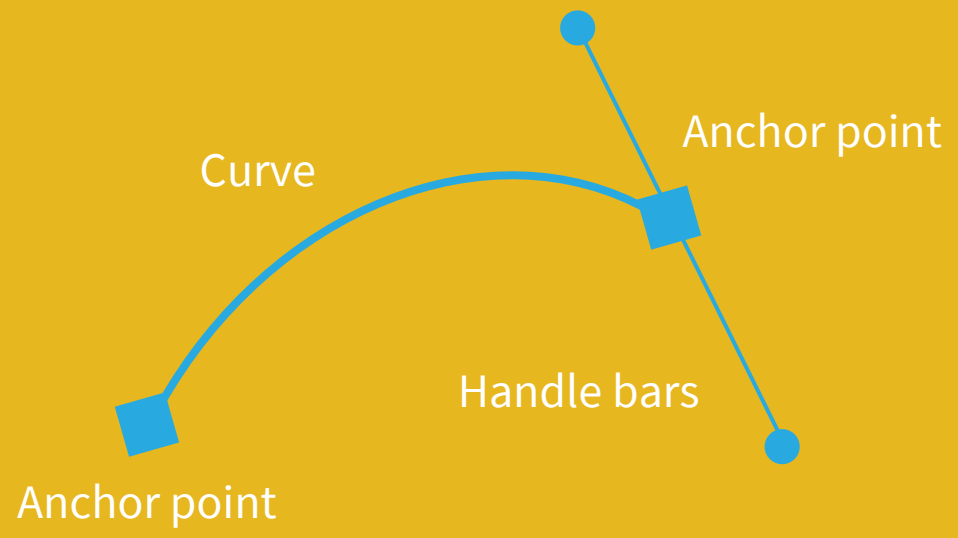
Lesson Objectives

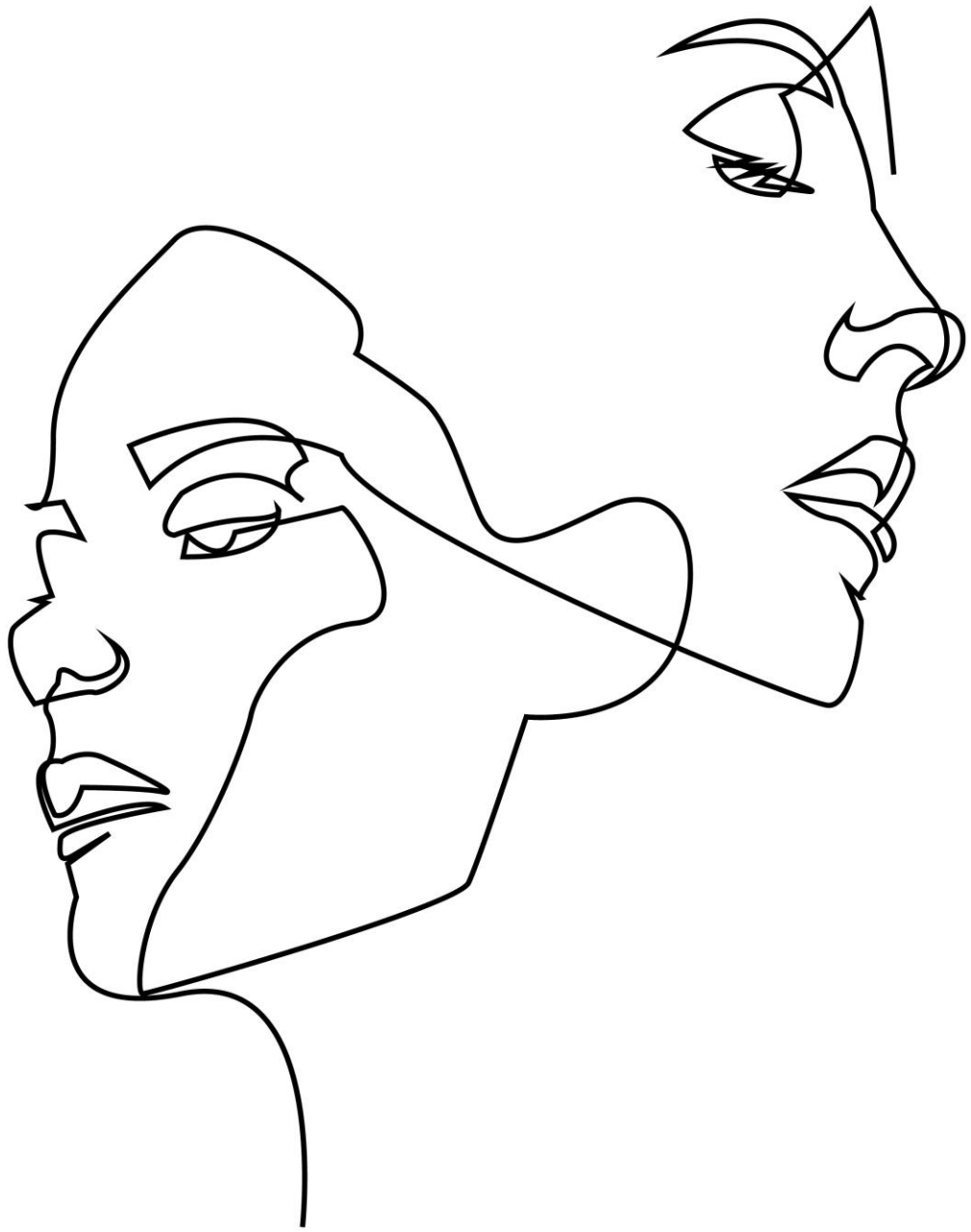
- Introduce the pen tool
- Explore the importance of the pen tool
- Discuss a drawing tablet
- Demonstrate how to use the pen tool

Introduction to the Pen Tool

What is The Pen Tool?

- Is a drawing tool
- Creates custom shapes and lines
- Anchor points (nodes)
- Adjusting curves with handle bars extended from anchor points





poster vector illustration

Why is the Pen Tool Important?

Importance of The Pen Tool

- Most powerful tool that is used the most
- Used in Illustrator, Photoshop & InDesign
- Create whatever your mind can think of

Do I Need a Drawing Tablet?

How Do I Use the Pen Tool?

How Do I Use The Pen Tool?

Illustrator
Digital illustrations
Logo creation & retracing
Type on a path

Photoshop
Digital illustrations
Deep-etching

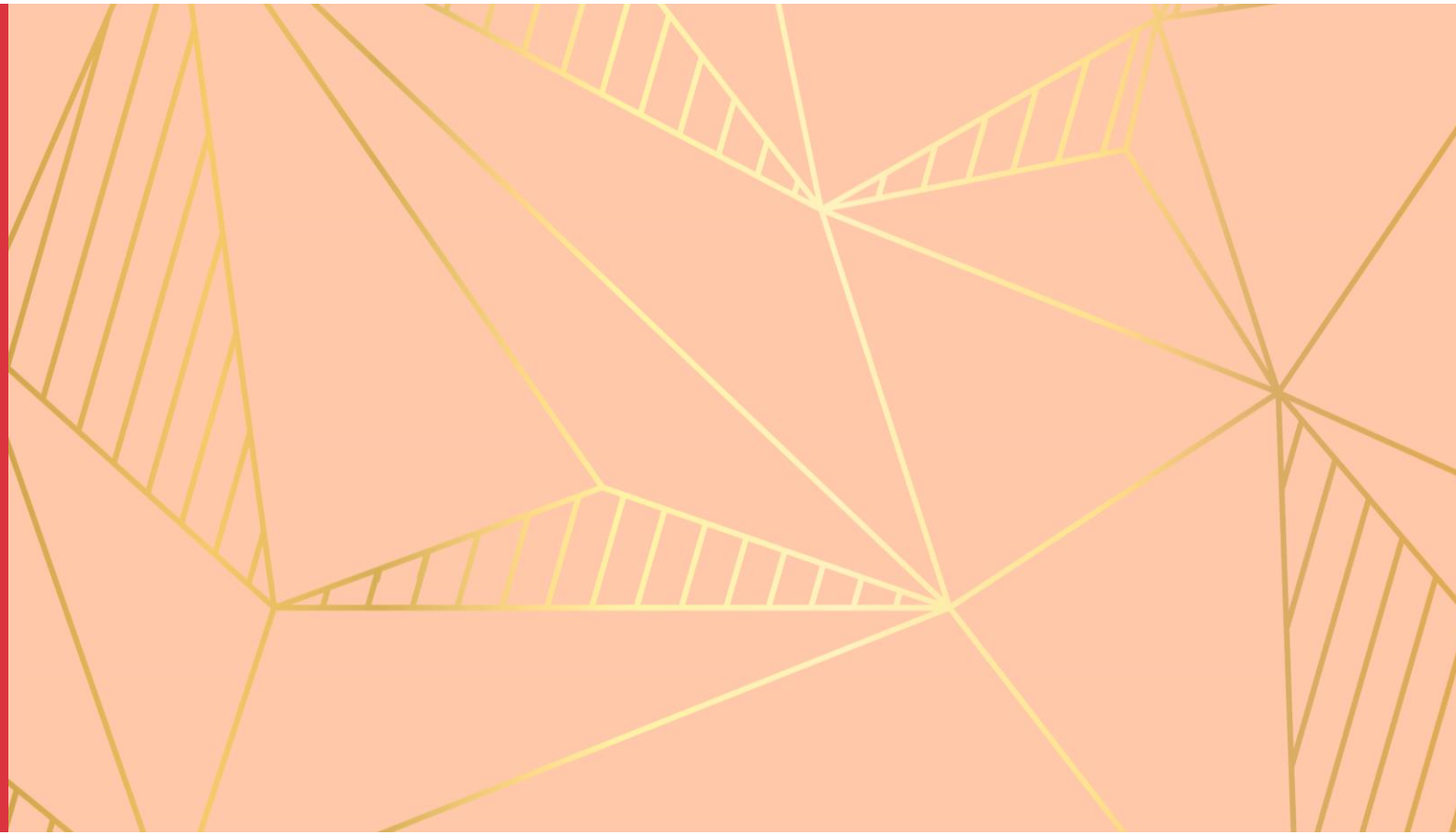
InDesign
Basic illustrations
Type on a path

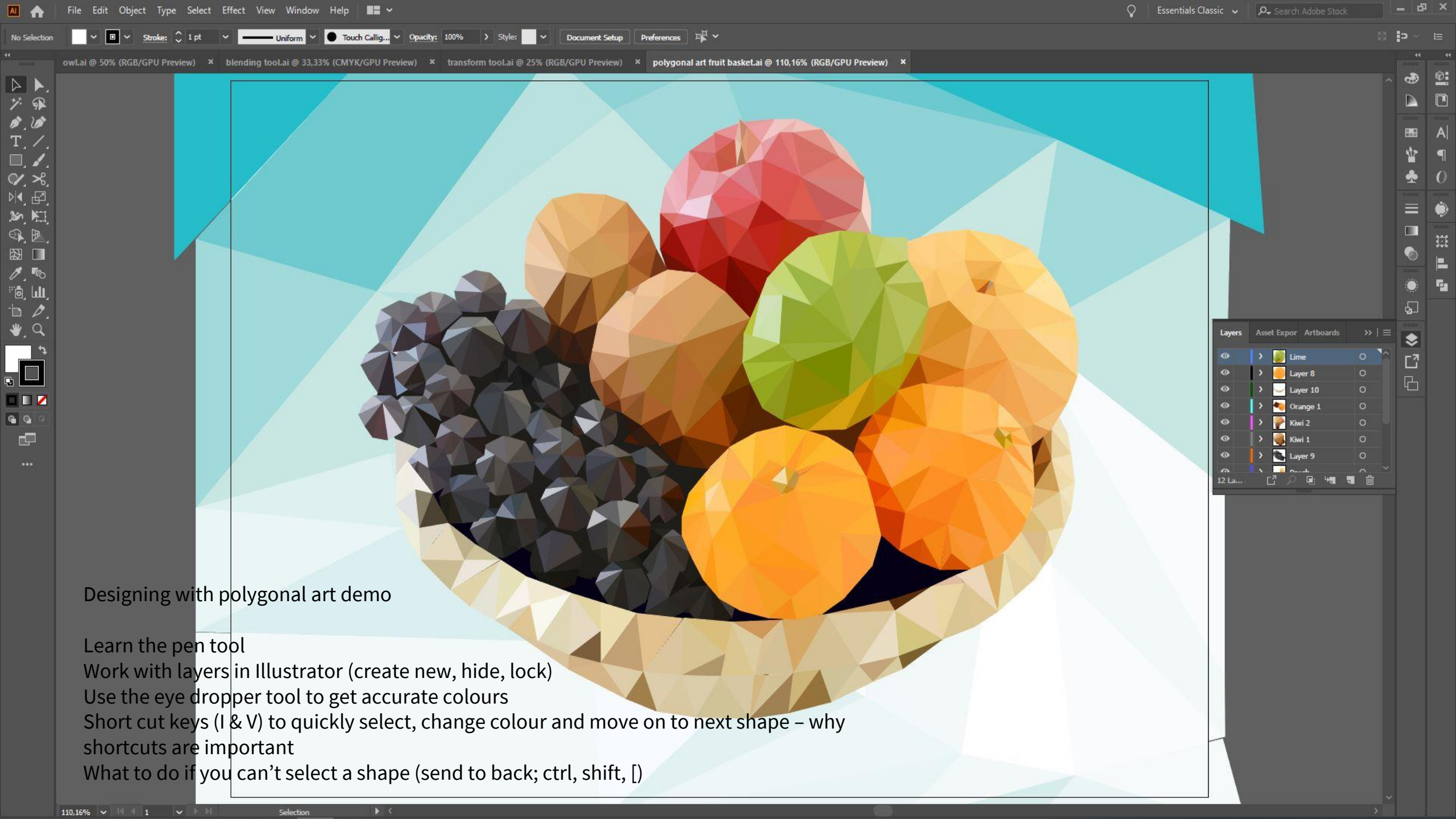
Demo
The Pen Tool

Illustrator

Polygonal art

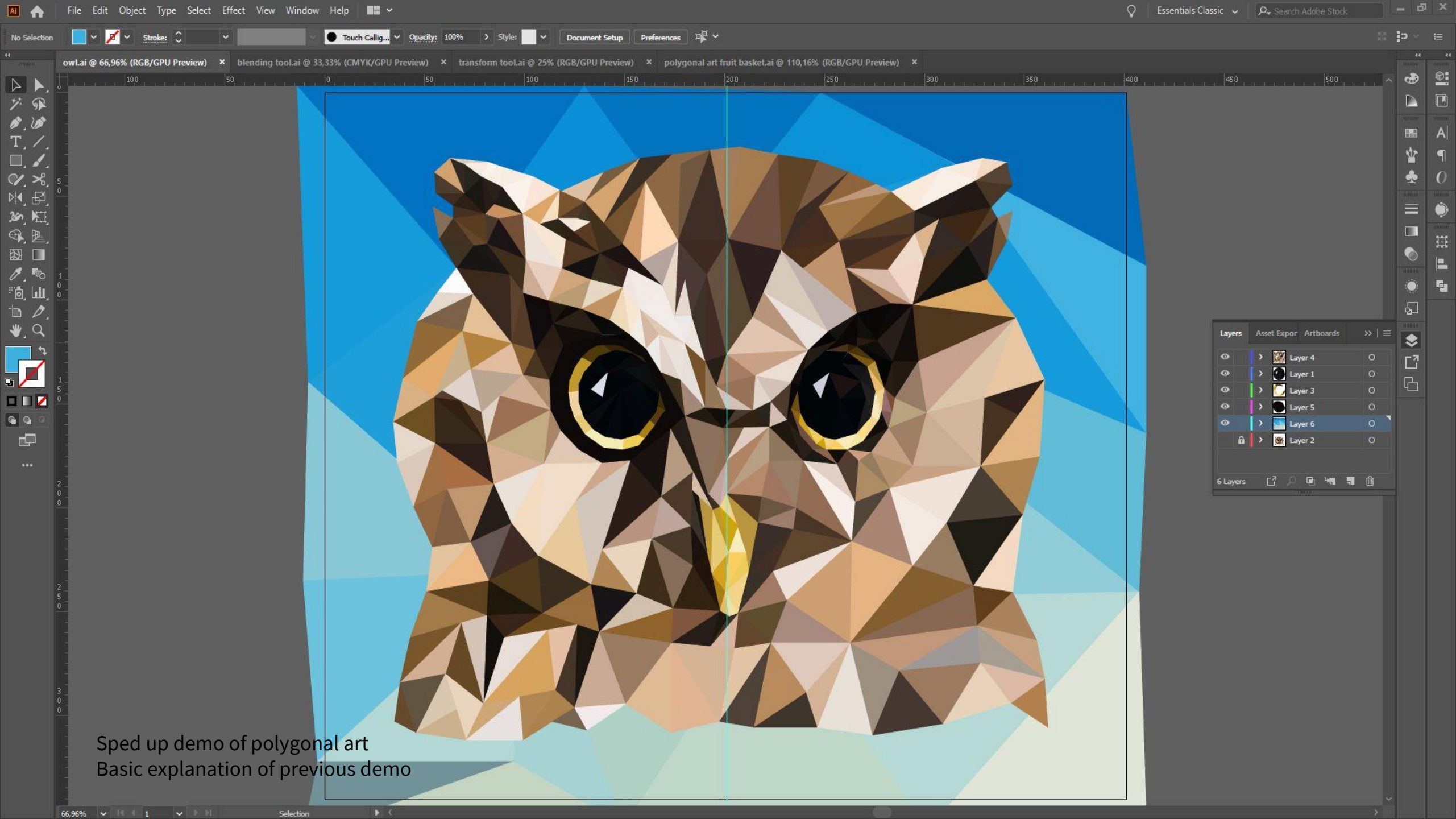
Image import & trace

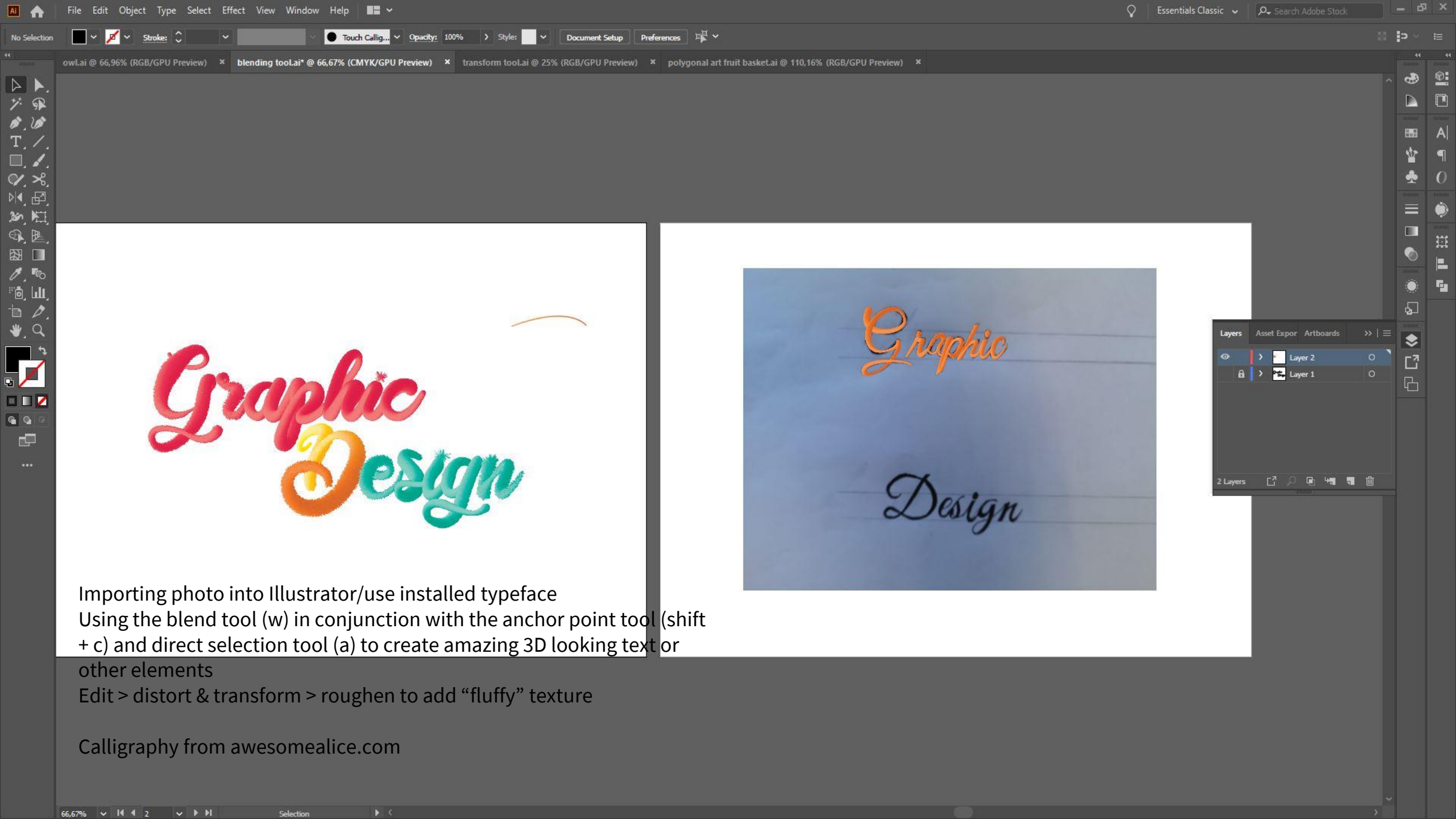




Designing with polygonal art demo

Learn the pen tool
Work with layers in Illustrator (create new, hide, lock)
Use the eye dropper tool to get accurate colours
Short cut keys (I & V) to quickly select, change colour and move on to next shape – why shortcuts are important
What to do if you can’t select a shape (send to back; ctrl, shift, [)


File Edit Object Type Select Effect View Window Help
Essentials Classic
Search Adobe Stock
No Selection
Stroke:
Touch Callig...
Opacity: 100%
Style:
Document Setup
Preferences
owl.ai @ 66,96% (RGB/GPU Preview)
blending tool.ai @ 33,33% (CMYK/GPU Preview)
transform tool.ai @ 25% (RGB/GPU Preview)
polygonal art fruit basket.ai @ 110,16% (RGB/GPU Preview)
Layers
Asset Expor
Artboards
Layer 4
Layer 1
Layer 3
Layer 5
Layer 6
Layer 2
6 Layers
66,96%
Selection
Sped up demo of polygonal art
Basic explanation of previous demo



Importing photo into Illustrator/use installed typeface
Using the blend tool (w) in conjunction with the anchor point tool (shift + c) and direct selection tool (a) to create amazing 3D looking text or other elements
Edit > distort & transform > roughen to add “fluffy” texture

Calligraphy from awesomealice.com

Challenge

- Take any photograph
- Create image in polygonal art style

CONGRATULATIONS

FOR COMPLETING YOUR LESSON!